

Research Methodology in Public Administration

Proposal Writing and Report Writing

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2026

Report Writing and Presentation

Communicating Research Findings Effectively

Research Problem



Data Collection



Data Analysis



Report Writing



Presentation

What is a Research Report?

A **research report** is a systematic written document that communicates the:

- ▶ Research problem
- ▶ Objectives and research questions
- ▶ Research methodology
- ▶ Data analysis and findings
- ▶ Discussion and interpretation
- ▶ Conclusions and recommendations

Purpose

A research report communicates what was studied, how it was studied, what was found, and what the findings mean.

From Research to Report



General Structure of a Research Report

A typical research report consists of:

1. Preliminary Pages
2. Introduction
3. Literature Review
4. Research Methodology
5. Data Analysis and Findings
6. Discussion
7. Summary, Conclusions and Recommendations
8. References and Appendices

Preliminary Pages

The preliminary section may include:

- ▶ Title Page
- ▶ Recommendation or Approval Page
- ▶ Declaration
- ▶ Acknowledgements
- ▶ Abstract
- ▶ Table of Contents
- ▶ List of Tables
- ▶ List of Figures
- ▶ List of Abbreviations

The exact format may vary according to the requirements of the university.

Writing an Effective Title

A good research title should be:

- ▶ Clear
- ▶ Specific
- ▶ Concise
- ▶ Informative
- ▶ Relevant to the study

Example

Citizen Satisfaction with Digital Public Service Delivery in Kathmandu Metropolitan City

Writing the Abstract

The **abstract** provides a brief summary of the entire study.

It generally includes:

1. Background or research problem
2. Objective of the study
3. Research methodology
4. Major findings
5. Main conclusion

Important

Although the abstract appears at the beginning of the report, it is usually written after the study is completed.

Chapter 1: Introduction

The introduction provides the overall context of the research.

It may include:

- ▶ Background of the study
- ▶ Statement of the problem
- ▶ Research objectives
- ▶ Research questions
- ▶ Research hypotheses, where applicable
- ▶ Significance of the study
- ▶ Scope and limitations
- ▶ Organization of the report

Chapter 2: Literature Review

The literature review explains what is already known about the research topic.

It should:

- ▶ Review relevant theories and concepts.
- ▶ Examine previous empirical studies.
- ▶ Compare and synthesize existing findings.
- ▶ Identify research gaps.
- ▶ Develop a conceptual or theoretical framework.

A literature review should not simply summarize one study after another.

Chapter 3: Research Methodology

The methodology chapter explains **how the research was conducted**.

It may include:

- ▶ Research philosophy and approach
- ▶ Research design
- ▶ Study population
- ▶ Sampling technique and sample size
- ▶ Sources of data
- ▶ Data collection methods
- ▶ Research instruments
- ▶ Data analysis methods
- ▶ Ethical considerations

Chapter 4: Data Analysis and Findings

This chapter presents the results of the study.

Depending on the research design, findings may include:

- ▶ Tables and figures
- ▶ Descriptive statistics
- ▶ Statistical tests
- ▶ Themes and categories
- ▶ Participant quotations
- ▶ Patterns and relationships

Key Question

What does the data show?

Chapter 5: Discussion

The discussion explains the meaning and implications of the findings.

The researcher should:

- ▶ Interpret the findings.
- ▶ Relate findings to research questions.
- ▶ Compare findings with previous studies.
- ▶ Connect findings with relevant theories.
- ▶ Explain unexpected findings.
- ▶ Discuss practical and theoretical implications.

Key Question

What do the findings mean?

Summary, Conclusions and Recommendations

Summary

Briefly presents the major aspects and findings of the study.

Conclusion

Provides the overall answer to the research problem based on the research findings.

Recommendations

Provides practical suggestions based on the findings and conclusions.

Characteristics of Good Recommendations

Good recommendations should be:

- ▶ Based on research findings
- ▶ Specific
- ▶ Practical
- ▶ Relevant
- ▶ Feasible
- ▶ Clearly connected to the conclusions

Avoid

Recommendations that are not supported by the findings of the study.

Principles of Academic Writing

Good academic writing should be:

- ▶ Clear
- ▶ Logical
- ▶ Objective
- ▶ Concise
- ▶ Evidence-based
- ▶ Well-organized
- ▶ Properly referenced

Clarity and Coherence in Writing

A good research report should have a logical flow.

Paragraph

→

Section

→

Chapter

→

Overall Argument

Each paragraph should generally contain:

1. A main idea
2. Supporting evidence
3. Explanation or interpretation
4. A logical connection to the next idea

Presenting Tables and Figures

Tables and figures should:

- ▶ Have a clear title.
- ▶ Be properly numbered.
- ▶ Be referred to in the text.
- ▶ Present relevant information.
- ▶ Be easy to understand.
- ▶ Mention the source when necessary.

Important

Do not simply repeat all the numbers from a table in the text. Highlight and interpret the most important findings.

Citation and Referencing

Academic writing requires proper acknowledgment of the work of other authors.

Citation helps to:

- ▶ Give credit to original authors.
- ▶ Support arguments with evidence.
- ▶ Avoid plagiarism.
- ▶ Allow readers to locate sources.

Common referencing styles include:

- ▶ APA
- ▶ Chicago
- ▶ Harvard

Avoiding Plagiarism

Plagiarism occurs when another person's ideas, words, or work are presented without proper acknowledgment.

Researchers should:

- ▶ Cite all sources appropriately.
- ▶ Use quotation marks for direct quotations.
- ▶ Paraphrase properly.
- ▶ Maintain accurate notes.
- ▶ Prepare references carefully.

Presenting Research Findings

A research presentation communicates the main elements of a study to an audience in a clear and concise manner.

A typical presentation may include:

1. Title and background
2. Research problem
3. Objectives and research questions
4. Literature and theoretical framework
5. Methodology
6. Major findings
7. Discussion
8. Conclusions and recommendations

Structure of an Oral Presentation



Preparing Effective Presentation Slides

Good presentation slides should:

- ▶ Focus on key points.
- ▶ Use clear and readable text.
- ▶ Avoid excessive information.
- ▶ Use tables and figures appropriately.
- ▶ Maintain a consistent design.
- ▶ Support the speaker rather than replace the speaker.

Remember

Slides are a visual aid, not a complete research report.

Communicating Research Findings

When presenting findings:

- ▶ Focus on the most important findings.
- ▶ Connect findings with research objectives.
- ▶ Use appropriate tables, graphs, or quotations.
- ▶ Explain what the findings mean.
- ▶ Avoid reading directly from slides.

Example: Presenting a Finding

Finding

Most respondents reported satisfaction with digital public services.

Instead of simply presenting the result, explain:

- ▶ What does this finding show?
- ▶ Why might this pattern exist?
- ▶ Does it support previous research?
- ▶ What are its policy implications?

Effective Presentation Skills

An effective presenter should:

- ▶ Know the audience.
- ▶ Practice the presentation.
- ▶ Manage time effectively.
- ▶ Speak clearly and confidently.
- ▶ Maintain appropriate eye contact.
- ▶ Use simple and understandable language.
- ▶ Respond carefully to questions.

Handling Questions and Discussion

When responding to questions:

1. Listen carefully to the question.
2. Take a moment to organize your response.
3. Answer directly and clearly.
4. Support your answer with evidence.
5. Acknowledge limitations when necessary.
6. Avoid becoming defensive.

Remember

It is acceptable to say that a question requires further investigation if the available evidence does not provide a clear answer.

Common Mistakes in Report Writing

Avoid:

- ▶ Lack of logical organization.
- ▶ Repetition of the same information.
- ▶ Unsupported claims.
- ▶ Weak connection between objectives and findings.
- ▶ Inconsistent tables and figures.
- ▶ Poor citation and referencing.
- ▶ Conclusions not supported by findings.

Common Mistakes in Presentations

Avoid:

- ▶ Reading directly from slides.
- ▶ Using too much text.
- ▶ Presenting too many tables.
- ▶ Using very small fonts.
- ▶ Exceeding the allocated time.
- ▶ Ignoring the research objectives.
- ▶ Presenting results without interpretation.

Final Checklist for a Research Report

Before submission, check:

- ▶ Is the research problem clearly stated?
- ▶ Are objectives and questions clearly addressed?
- ▶ Is the methodology adequately explained?
- ▶ Are findings presented clearly?
- ▶ Is the discussion linked to the literature?
- ▶ Are conclusions supported by findings?
- ▶ Are recommendations practical and evidence-based?
- ▶ Are citations and references complete?

Final Checklist for Presentation

Before presenting, ask:

- ▶ Is the presentation logically organized?
- ▶ Are the research objectives clear?
- ▶ Have I selected only the key findings?
- ▶ Are the slides readable?
- ▶ Can I complete the presentation within the time limit?
- ▶ Have I practiced answering possible questions?

Key Takeaway

Good research must be communicated effectively.

Research



Analysis



Interpretation



Report Writing



Presentation

Thank You

Questions and Discussion